Setting Up a Status Page to Monitor Cloud Infrastructure

Cloud infrastructure must be continuously monitored to pre-empt service failures. Monitoror and Vigil are two excellent open source tools to help set up status pages for black box monitoring of IT infrastructure.

Modern cloud infrastructures are complicated and run both internal and external servers to deliver products and services 24/7. Keeping a close watch on each element of this infrastructure is critical for any technology-driven business, and monitoring solutions need to be proactive rather than reactive. Having an internal and/or external status page, which gives a quick overview to figure out what's failing where, is a must-have tool for any modern IT team. Most enterprise monitoring solutions are way too expensive, especially for small to medium businesses. Let's look at two amazing free and open source solutions to set up various kinds of status pages for black box monitoring of IT infrastructure. All you need to test these solutions is a running Docker engine on your machine, which is pretty common nowadays.

Monitoror wallboard

Our first free and open source status page solution is Monitoror. It's also known as a monitoring wallboard as it's a single page app consisting of different coloured rectangular tiles. Monitoror mainly has three kinds of general-purpose monitoring checks: ping, port and HTTP. The ping check verifies connectivity to a configured host, the port check verifies the port listening on a configured endpoint, and the HTTP check verifies the GET request to a URL. It also has special inbuilt checks for Azure DevOps, GitHub, GitLab, Jenkins, Pingdom and TravisCI. The wallboard highlights the configured tiles either in green or red based on whether a check passes or fails, respectively.

Now let's see Monitoror in action. First, create a Docker network for test container(s) to communicate through the command *docker network create statuspage-demo* in a terminal. Next, create *monitoror_stack.yml* and *config.json* as shown below to launch a Monitoror stack and supply its configuration for our first demo, respectively. Here's the content for *monitoror_stack.yml* and *config.json:*

monitoror_stack.yml

```
services:
  monitoror:
    image: monitoror/monitoror:${MTRRTAG:-latest}
    ports:
```